

The Retained-Distinction Tensor Field Theory

Supplementary Material: the full derivation, root to curvature, as one continuous machine-checked thread over $\mathbb{Q}$

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Companion to the main manuscript • July 6, 2026

Preprint notice. This supplement is a preprint and has not yet undergone formal peer review. Every step below tagged [Th_coqc] is independently confirmable by recompiling the delivered Coq sources under coqc 8.20.1 (exit status 0, `Print Assumptions = Closed under the global context`). The reader is invited to audit rather than believe.

How to read this supplement. This is one continuous logical thread. It starts from a single root — the retained difference (RD), i.e. distinguishability — and never leaves the rationals $\mathbb{Q}$. Each step gives (i) the *statement*, (ii) the *Coq theorem / file* that closes it, (iii) its *tier tag*, and (iv) one line of *why* it follows from the step before. The framing invariant is fixed throughout: **the discrete tensor PDE over $\mathbb{Q}$ IS the theory**; the continuum is never a target, gate, or aspiration — it is a [Refused] non-readout (§7).

1 The root: retained difference

Step 0 — RD is the only primitive. *Statement.* The single primitive is the *retained difference* δ_R : whether two states are distinguished *and* that distinction is kept. Everything downstream is a readout of retained differences; no continuum, no real number, and no dimensionful constant is assumed prior to a readout. *Tier.* [Dr] (the programme postulate; every object it generates is then tiered on its own). *Why.* A theory that only ever reads finite retained distinctions can be carried entirely in $\mathbb{Q}$, which is what makes every later step machine-checkable and axiom-free.

Step 1 — distinctions become graph weights.

Statement. Retained differences between nodes i, j are recorded as non-negative weights w_{ij} on the edges of a graph G ; a node's total retained distinction is its weighted degree $d_i = \sum_j w_{ij}$. *Tier.* [Dr] over [Th_coqc] objects. *Why.* A weight is just a kept difference given a name; the graph is the minimal object on which “how much is distinguished, and from what” is a finite readout.

2 The root operator: the retained-distinction Laplacian

Step 2 — $L_R = D_W - W$ is forced. *Statement.* The operator that reads “net retained difference at a node relative to its neighbours” is the graph Laplacian

$$L_R = D_W - W, \quad (L_R \phi)_i = \sum_j w_{ij} (\phi_i - \phi_j),$$

with $D_W = \text{diag}(d_i)$. On a 1D chain of unit weights this is exactly the *second finite difference* $(L_R \phi)_j = -(\phi_{j+1} - 2\phi_j + \phi_{j-1})$. *Coq.* core `URCF_RD_All`; second-difference identity `riemann_fd = w(S(S j)) - 2 w(S j) + w j` in `InfoDiscreteRiemannCurvature.v`. *Tier.* [Th_coqc]. *Why.* $L_R = D_W - W$ is the unique symmetric, difference-only operator that annihilates constants (no distinction $\Rightarrow$ no readout) — it is the discrete spatial-geometry axis, taken as an exact difference, never as ∂_{xx} in a limit.

3 The spine PDE

Step 3 — the master equation. *Statement.* Let Φ be the retained-distinction field over the nodes (tensor-valued once an internal index space is attached). Balancing inertia, dissipation and the geometric coupling gives the one master equation

$$M \partial_{tt} \Phi + D \partial_t \Phi - K \cdot L_R \cdot \Phi + \nabla V(\Phi) = J - \eta$$

with M inertia, D dissipation, K coupling, V self-interaction, J source, η readout/back-reaction. Setting $V \equiv 0$, $J = \eta$ leaves the *spine* $M \partial_{tt} \Phi + D \partial_t \Phi + K L_R \Phi = 0$. *Coq.* core `InfoSchrodinger / InfoDecoherence / InfoTelegraph`. *Tier.* spine identity [Th_coqc]; the tensor-PDE envelope reading [Dr]. *Why.* The three named readouts are the three pieces of *one* equation: $M \partial_{tt}$ alone $\rightarrow$ unitary oscillation (wave/quantum), $D \partial_t$ alone $\rightarrow$ dissipative decay (diffusion), and their sum on $L_R \rightarrow$ the telegraph equation of Step 5.

Step 4 — the actual update (no continuum ∂).

Statement. On an L_R -eigenmode λ , ∂_{tt} and ∂_t are finite differences; the field advances by the two-register (position/velocity) update

$$X[n+1] = X[n] + \Delta \theta_R V[n],$$

$$V[n+1] = V[n] + \Delta \theta_R (K L_R \Phi - D V[n] - \nabla V(\Phi) + J - \eta) / M,$$

with n the tick counter and $\Delta\theta_R$ the retained-distinction phase increment (*not* physical dt ; Clock Registry, main text). *Coq.* `decay-ratio / backward-Euler brick InfoDecayRatioFromTauC.v`. *Tier.* [Th.coqc] (the continuum $\exp(-\Gamma_{\text{damp}}t)$, with damping rate $\Gamma_{\text{damp}} = D/(2M)$, is I2, [Refused]). *Why.* The update is the spine *as arithmetic over* $\mathbb{Q}$: every quantity is a finite readout and no limit is ever taken — the discrete dynamics is primary, not an approximation to a smooth one.

Step 4' — the same spine as a stationary action. *Statement.* Over one node-window $p \rightarrow m \rightarrow q$ the discrete window action

$$A_{\text{win}}(m) = M|q - m|^2 + M|m - p|^2 - h^2 K \text{gform}(m, m)$$

is stationary, $\partial A_{\text{win}}/\partial m = 0$, exactly on the update of Step 4. *Coq.* `InfoActionStationarity.v` (with `InfoGeodesicActionStationarity` giving $M \text{acc} = \frac{1}{2}\gamma \text{vel}^2$, the exact discretisation of $M\ddot{x} = -\frac{1}{2}M'\dot{x}^2$). *Tier.* [Th.coqc]. *Why.* Stationarity is proved as an exact ring identity, not a variation-in-the-limit, so the Euler-Lagrange envelope is a $\mathbb{Q}$ -readout on equal footing with the update.

4 Telegraph form and mass

Step 5 — the spine IS the telegraph equation; $M = 1/2\tau_c$. *Statement.* The spine $M\partial_{tt}\Phi + D\partial_t\Phi + KL_R\Phi = 0$ is *literally* the telegraph equation, and matching the damping to the retained-distinction correlation time τ_c fixes the mass

$$M = \frac{1}{2\tau_c}.$$

Coq. `core InfoTelegraph`. *Tier.* [Th.coqc] (mass identity exact over $\mathbb{Q}$). *Why.* Mass is not inserted — it is *read out* of the dissipative time-scale of the same equation, closing “what is inertia” in terms of the RD root alone.

5 The discriminant crossover

Step 6 — one algebraic knife-edge splits the regimes. *Statement.* The temporal characteristic on an L_R -eigenmode λ is $p_{\text{char}} = M\omega^2 + D\omega + K\lambda$, with discriminant and crossover

$$\text{disc} = D^2 - 4MK\lambda, \quad \lambda_c = \frac{D^2}{4MK},$$

and the exact completion of the square $4Mp_{\text{char}} = (2M\omega + D)^2 - \text{disc}$. *Coq.* `InfoTelegraphCrossover.v`: `char_complete_square`, `critical_disc_zero`, `underdamped_iff_above_crit`. *Tier.* [Th.coqc]. *Why.* The single sign of disc decides everything below, and it is fixed by an exact algebraic identity, not a numerical threshold.

Step 6a — under-damped = quantum. *Statement.* For $\text{disc} < 0$, $p_{\text{char}} > 0$ for every real ω : no real frequency root, hence oscillatory (wave/quantum, the `InfoSchrodinger` side). *Coq.* `underdamped_positive`. *Tier.* [Th.coqc]. *Why.* A strictly positive characteristic has only complex roots — looping, not settling.

Step 6b — over-damped = classical. *Statement.* For $\text{disc} \geq 0$, $p_{\text{char}} \leq 0$ at $\omega = -D/2M$: a real decay root exists, hence pure decay (diffusion/classical, the `InfoDecoherence` side). *Coq.* `overdamped_min_nonpositive`. *Tier.* [Th.coqc]. *Why.* A real root is a settling mode — the classical branch is where distinction relaxes.

Step 6c — witnesses. *Statement.* $(M, D, K, \lambda) = (1, 1, 1, 1) \Rightarrow \text{disc} = -3 < 0$ (under-damped/quantum); $(1, 4, 1, 1) \Rightarrow \text{disc} = 12 > 0$ (over-damped/classical). *Tier.* [finite_diagnostic]. *Why.* Both regimes are actually realised over $\mathbb{Q}$, so the crossover is non-vacuous.

Step 6d — the crossover IS the horizon = agency knife-edge. *Statement.* The telegraph disc is the core `InfoFrontier.spine_discr`, and λ_c is `spine_lambda_c`; the oscillatory (quantum) regime is exactly *above* the horizon. *Coq.* `InfoTelegraphHorizonUnification.v`: `disc_is_spine_discr`, `lam_c_is_spine_lambda_c`, `quantum_iff_above_horizon`, `oscillatory_above_horizon`. *Tier.* [Th.coqc]; reading [Dr]. *Why.* One knife-edge unifies quantum $\leftrightarrow$ classical (dynamics), the black-hole horizon (GR), and the agency threshold: looping above, settling at or below.

6 The discrete curvature tensor

Here $K \cdot L_R$ (Step 2–3) is unfolded into a full discrete curvature tensor, still entirely over $\mathbb{Q}$, still division-free where it matters.

Step 7 — Christoffel = first difference (and $\neq$ curvature). *Statement.* The connection is the first finite difference `christoffel_fd w j = w(S j) - w j`. An affine weight gives a *nonzero* Christoffel yet *zero* curvature. *Coq.* `InfoDiscreteRiemannCurvature.v`: `christoffel_can_be_nonzero_while_flat`. *Tier.* [Th.coqc]. *Why.* Curvature must be a *second-order* object; a nonzero connection that is still flat proves the first difference alone is gauge, not geometry.

Step 8 — Riemann = second difference. *Statement.* `riemann_fd = w(S(S j)) - 2w(S j) + w j`; affine $\Rightarrow$ flat, and the non-affine witness $w = qn^2$ gives `riemann_fd0 = 2  $\neq$  0`; flat $\Leftrightarrow$ locally affine (arithmetic progression). *Coq.* `riemann_is_second_difference`, `affine_is_flat`, `curvature_nonzero_witness`, `flat_iff_second_diff_zero`. *Tier.* [Th.coqc]. *Why.* This is the same second difference that defines L_R (Step 2): geometry and the root operator are the same object read curvature-first.

Step 9 — Riemann = group commutator (Heisenberg, division-free). *Statement.* Genuinely two-index curvature is the group commutator on the Heisenberg / upper-unipotent group (polynomial inverse, so *no division*): R_{xy} = the centre of $[X, Y] = a \cdot b$, with $[Y, X] = -a \cdot b$; abelian, scalar, and same-direction plaquettes are all flat. *Coq.* `InfoDiscreteRiemannCommutator.v: plaquette_curvature_z, reverse_antisymmetric, curvature_is_central`. *Tier.* [Th.coqc]. *Why.* Holonomy around a plaquette is a commutator; realising it in a nilpotent *group* keeps everything in $\mathbb{Q}$ and delivers kl-antisymmetry exactly, without any limit or inverse.

Step 10 — ij-antisymmetry + Jacobi = first Bianchi ($\mathfrak{so}(3)$). *Statement.* On the metric-compatible algebra $\mathfrak{so}(3) \cong (\mathbb{Q}^3, \times)$ the generator `asym u` is antisymmetric, the matrix commutator satisfies $[\text{asym } u, \text{asym } w] = \text{asym}(u \times w)$, curvature is ij-antisymmetric, and the *Jacobi identity is the first Bianchi identity*. *Coq.* `InfoMetricCompatibleCurvature.v: asym_is_antisymmetric, commutator_is_asym_cross, curvature_ij_antisymmetric, bianchi_jacobi`. *Tier.* [Th.coqc]. *Why.* Metric compatibility forces the connection into $\mathfrak{so}(3)$, where the cross product closes the bracket and the algebraic Bianchi identity is just Jacobi — proven, division-free.

Step 11 — rational $SO(2)/SO(3)$ isometry (Cayley). *Statement.* Genuine rotations exist over $\mathbb{Q}$: $SO(2)$ via the Cayley / Pythagorean map $N = (I - A)\text{adj}(I + A)$ with $N^\top N = (1 + t^2)^2 I$; and a rational $SO(3)$ capstone (two $(3, 4, 5)$ rotations, holonomy $\neq I$) carrying nonzero rational curvature. *Coq.* `InfoRationalIsometry.v, InfoRationalS03Curvature.v`. *Tier.* [Th.coqc]. *Why.* Transport must be an isometry; the Cayley map gives exact rational orthogonal transport with *no* $\sqrt{\cdot}$, so curved holonomy is a $\mathbb{Q}$ -readout.

Step 12 — metric-derived Levi-Civita (rational, g^{-1} no $\sqrt{g}$). *Statement.* From a metric $g = \text{diag}(1, w)$ the Levi-Civita symbol $\Gamma_{12}^2 = \frac{1}{2} dw/w$ is rational for $w \neq 0$ (it needs only g^{-1} , never $\sqrt{g}$), and $R_{1212} = -\frac{1}{2} d^2 w + (dw)^2 / (4w)$: flat on constant w , curved witness $R_{1212} = -\frac{1}{4}$. *Coq.* `InfoMetricDerivedCurvature.v: christoffel_G212_rational, flat_constant_zero_curvature, curved_witness`. *Tier.* [Th.coqc]. *Why.* The connection is *derived from the metric* (not posited) and remains rational because only the inverse metric enters; the square root that an orthonormal frame would demand is exactly the object refused in Step 14.

Step 13 — second Bianchi $dF = 0$; pair symmetry derived. *Statement.* The abelian differential Bianchi identity holds on the 3D lattice, $d_z F_{xy} + d_x F_{yz} + d_y F_{zx} = 0$, from mixed-difference commutation (nonzero-curvature witness, not vacuous); and

the pair symmetry $R_{ijkl} = R_{klij}$ is *derived* from A1 (ij-antisym) + A2 (kl-antisym) + B1 (first Bianchi), for abstract R over $\mathbb{Q}$. *Coq.* `InfoDiscreteSecondBianchi.v: second_bianchi, mixed_differences_commute; InfoRiemannPairSymmetry.v: pair_symmetry`. *Tier.* [Th.coqc]. *Why.* With all four Riemann symmetries (kl-antisym, ij-antisym, first Bianchi, pair symmetry) and both Bianchi identities machine-checked, the discrete curvature tensor is *structurally complete* (cpg DEC-curvature-chain-complete).

7 The $\sqrt{g}$ frame refused (I1 non-readout)

Step 14 — where the thread stops, on purpose. *Statement.* An orthonormal frame requires $\sqrt{g}$. For a non-perfect-square metric such as $\text{diag}(1, 2)$ there is *no rational frame*: the frame is an I1 injected infinity ($\mathbb{R}$ -completeness), while the connection and curvature of Step 12 stay rational. *Coq.* `InfoMetricFrameNonReadout.v: metric_frame_diag12_no_rational`. *Tier.* [Th.coqc] $\rightarrow$ [Refused]. *Why.* The theory reads the geometry through g^{-1} (rational), and *declines* the frame: $\sqrt{g}$ is a non-readout no agency ever reads, so it is refused as a *position, verified where refused* — not a gap. This is the local face of the Continuum Refusal that replaces any “graph-to-continuum” gate: the discrete tensor PDE over $\mathbb{Q}$ is complete on its own terms.

8 The naive non-abelian Bianchi defect

Step 15 — an honest negative, exactly measured. *Statement.* Extending the differential Bianchi identity to the non-abelian (group) case by the *naive* covariant difference fails, and it fails by an exact amount: the Leibniz defect

$$(\text{naive covariant Bianchi defect}) = \text{cross}(dA, dB).$$

Coq. `InfoDiscreteLeibnizObstruction.v`. *Tier.* [Th.coqc] (an exact identity for the *defect*). *Why.* The finite Leibniz rule carries a cross-term that a genuine non-abelian Bianchi identity must absorb through transport; measuring the defect exactly is what turns the correct non-abelian statement into a well-posed *positive* target (Step O2), rather than a vague “does it work” question.

9 The honest ledger

Nothing in §§1–8 tagged [Th.coqc] is open: the RD root, L_R , the spine PDE, the telegraph mass, the discriminant crossover, and the entire curvature tensor (Steps 7–13, all four symmetries and both Bianchi identities) are closed, axiom-free results over $\mathbb{Q}$. What remains is cleanly split into *genuine positive extensions* and *refused non-readouts*. The two must not be confused.

[Open] — **genuine positive research targets (not gaps in the closed results).**

[Open] **O1 — full R^i_{jkl} in $n \geq 3$.** The complete metric-derived Riemann array satisfying all symmetries, from a general (non-diagonal, non-affine) metric g — beyond the $\text{diag}(1, w)$ single component R_{1212} of Step 12.

[Open] **O2 — exact non-abelian (group) second Bianchi.** In transport / holonomy-cube form; the naive covariant form provably fails by the exact defect cross(dA, dB) of Step 15, so the correct statement needs the transport-corrected cube.

[Open] **O3 — general parametrised $SO(n)$ family.** Tied to a metric g ; $n = 2$ ($SO(2)$) and a witnessed rational $SO(3)$ are closed (Step 11), the general family is open.

[Open] **O4 — Schrödinger reduction and absolute constants.** The non-relativistic Schrödinger reduction, and the numeric values of the absolute constants M, D, K, τ_c — OPEN.CONSTANTS: there is no external anchor for these absolute values, and none is claimed. The complex/real *root magnitudes* of the telegraph characteristic are *not* listed here: their *sign/regime* over $\mathbb{Q}$ is already [Th_coqc] (Step 6), and their transcendental *values* are [Refused] (below), not an unfinished target.

[Refused] — **non-readouts declined on thesis grounds (not gaps; §7).**

[Refused] The **continuum** Riemann tensor / smooth d^2g , $d\Gamma$, and any continuum limit of the spine PDE (I2, $h \rightarrow 0$).

[Refused] The **orthonormal frame** $\sqrt{g}$ (I1) — proven non-readout for non-perfect-square g (Step 14).

[Refused] **Born-rule uniqueness** (I1).

[Refused] The **real/complex root magnitudes** of the telegraph characteristic — the transcendental phase/rate *values* in +reals (I1 non-readout). The *sign/regime* over $\mathbb{Q}$ is [Th_coqc] (Step 6); the magnitude *values* are declined, not left [Open].

[Refused] Full continuum GR / Einstein dynamical closure *as a target*; the GR content enters only through the discrete $K \cdot L_R$ geometry readout and the horizon knife-edge (Step 6d), both [Th_coqc].

Do not tag any of Steps 2–13 [Open]: the discrete tensorial spine and the curvature chain are closed [Th_coqc]. The absolute constant values are [Open] (no anchor, none claimed); the continuum and $\sqrt{g}$ are [Refused]. The continuum is the map, not the territory.

Supantarika for her support and encouragement in the broader development of this project. Any remaining errors are solely the author’s own.

Author Declarations

Funding. No specific grant from any funding agency in the public, commercial, or not-for-profit sectors was received.

Competing Interests. The author declares no competing interests.

AI Assistance Disclosure. Artificial-intelligence tools were used in an assistive capacity for the mechanized proof development, numerical pre-verification, language support, and editorial refinement. All substantive constructions, proof strategies, interpretive judgments, and final decisions were made and verified by the author, and every machine-checked claim is independently confirmable by the `coqc` kernel.

Code Availability. The Coq sources of every machine-checked claim, maintained at <https://github.com/morrocwi/causal-quantum-gravity> (formal/, with a `Makefile` and reproduction commands), constitute the artifact and reproduce every machine-checked claim of-line; each file compiles under `coqc 8.20.1` with exit status 0 and `Print Assumptions = Closed under the global context`. Every commit is additionally re-verified end-to-end by continuous integration (`make verify` on GitHub Actions); the badge is the authoritative live count.

Acknowledgements

This work was developed through Open-Civil Science, within a polycentric epistemology of Human–AI co-thinking. The author gratefully acknowledges Walancha